

NAVMANI



WRITTEN BY
ISHAAN KR. SINGH

NAVMANI

Chapter 1: Interlude

Deep freeze chamber mein ek halki si roshni thi — neeli, dheemi, jaise saans le rahi ho.

Om andar tha. Do din ho chuke the. Sirf do din.

Par bahar — bahar kuch ruka nahi tha.

Gauri lab ke ek corner mein baithi thi, laptop khula, par screen par kuch dikh nahi raha tha usse. Aankhein screen par thi, dimaag kahin aur.

Kya hua tha wahan? Om achanak gayab kaise ho gaya tha teen din ke liye? Aur ab ye deep freeze — bina poori baat bataye?

Kenji USA ja chuke the. Kaam ke silsile mein — ya shayad kisi aur wajah se, kisi ne poora nahi poochha. Par unke jaane ke baad saari jimmedari — IKS ki, hospital ki, sab kuch — Bhuvan aur Mikhail ke kandhon par aa gayi thi.

Aur wo kandhe abhi kaafi bhaari mehsoos kar rahe the.

Sanjivani launch ho chuki thi. Naya hospital, naya device — sab kuch perfect lag raha tha inauguration ke din. Par kuch hafton mein hi cheezein badalne lagi.

Cases aane lage.

Zyada nahi — par itne ki ignore na kiya ja sake. Kuch patients jinhone Sanjivani se treatment li thi, unme side effects dikhne lage — ajeeb, unexplained, aise jo pehle kabhi record nahi hue the.

Media ne pakad liya.

Headlines chalne lage — "IKS ka naya device — kya jaldi mein launch kiya gaya?" Debate shows mein experts baithe, sawaal uthaye. Bhuvan aur Mikhail din raat calls le rahe the — journalists, doctors, investors — sabko jawab dena tha aur jawab thae hi nahi.

Phir achanak — sab shant ho gaya.

Ek chhoti si coaching chalane wale teacher ki koi controversy news mein aa gayi — kuch local scandal, kuch aisa jo Sanjivani se bilkul bhi related nahi tha. Par media ka dhyan wahan chala gaya. Poori tarah.

Sanjivani ki baat dab gayi. Jaise kabhi thi hi nahi.

Bhuvan aur Mikhail ke liye rahat thi — par ek ajeeb si rahat. Kyunki asli sawaal — cases kyun aa rahe the — uska jawab abhi bhi nahi mila tha.

Raat ka waqt tha.

Lab mein teen log baithe the — Bhuvan, Mikhail, Gauri. Table par coffee ke cups the, thande ho chuke.

Mikhail ne Gauri ki taraf dekha. "Koi tareeka mila kya? Om ke saath jo hua uske baare mein?"

Gauri ne sar hilaya. "Nahi."

Awaaz mein thakaan thi. Do din se yahi kar rahi thi — dhundna, sochna, khud se ladna — aur kuch nahi mila tha.

Khamoshi chhayi kuch der.

Phir Bhuvan ne apni aankhein masalti hue kaha, "Sanjivani ke cases badhte ja rahe hain. Jaldi se jaldi solve karna hoga — nahi toh ye sirf ek PR problem nahi rahegi."

Uski awaaz mein thakaan se zyada ek chinta thi.

Tabhi peeche se chhoti si footsteps ki awaaz aayi.

Avika.

Neend bhari aankhon ke saath, apne haath mein ek kagaz liye, seedhi Bhuvan ke paas aayi aur uski godi mein baith gayi.

"Papa, dekho," usne kaha, kagaz aage karte hue.

Bhuvan ne dekha — ek painting thi. Crayons se banayi hui — panch figures, alag alag colors mein, sab ek line mein khade.

"Ye kaun kaun hai?" Bhuvan ne poochha, muskurate hue.

Avika ne ungli se ek ek figure ki taraf ishaara kiya. "Ye Kenji dada. Ye Papa aap. Ye Mummy Ye Om uncle. Aur ye Gauri aunty."

Sab chup ho gaye ek pal ke liye.

"Ye apne paas rakho," Avika ne kaha, kagaz Bhuvan ke haath mein rakhte hue. "Main sone ja rahi hoon."

Bhuvan ne painting li — dheere se, jaise koi bahut kimti cheez ho. Usne apni jacket ki andar wali pocket mein rakh di.

"So ja beta," usne kaha.

Avika chali gayi. Kamre mein wapas wahi khamoshi aa gayi — par ab thodi alag lag rahi thi.

Sab apne apne room mei so gaye.

Agli subah.

Gauri wapas apne kaam mein lag gayi thi — laptop khula, screens par data. Par uska dimaag abhi bhi wahi tha — Om, wo teen din, wo gayab hona.

Tabhi ek khayal aaya.

Usne SAHAY ka interface khola.

"SAHAY," usne kaha. "Tum toh saari cheezein detail mein bata sakte ho na? Om ke saath jo hua — wahan kya hua tha?"

SAHAY ne ek pal liya.

"Bata toh sakta hoon," SAHAY ne kaha. "Par uske liye — abhi jitne live systems main chala raha hoon, wo sab band ho jayenge."

Gauri ruk gayi.

Cut to —

Mikhail bahar khadi thi, IKS ki building ke gate ke paas. Saamne se Sanjivani ke trucks nikal rahe the — roz ki tarah, medicines aur devices leke.

Usne aise hi dekha — normal si baat.

Par phir kuch notice hua.

Main distributor jis raste se roz jaata tha — Mikhail ne wo raasta hazaron baar dekha tha — aaj truck uske opposite raste se ja raha tha.

Uska dimaag ruk gaya ek pal.

Ye galat raasta hai.

Usne ek pal aur dekha — confirm karne ke liye. Haan. Wahi truck, par direction ulti.

Mikhail seedha andar bhaagi. Seedha Bhuvan ke paas.

"Bhuvan," usne kaha, saans thodi tez. "Sanjivani ka main distributor truck — wo apne normal raaste se nahi ja raha. Opposite direction mein gaya hai."

Bhuvan ki aankhein sakht ho gayi. "Kab se?"

"Abhi dekha maine."

Bhuvan ne ek second nahi liya. "SAHAY — trace karo us truck ko. Abhi."

"Trace kar raha hoon," SAHAY ne kaha.

Screen par map khula, ek dot chalne laga —

Aur phir —

Beech mein hi, achanak, SAHAY ki awaaz ruk gayi. Screen freeze ho gaya.

"SAHAY?" Bhuvan ne kaha.

Koi jawab nahi.

Bhuvan aur Mikhail ek doosre ko dekhne lage — confuse. Tabhi Bhuvan ki nazar Gauri par gayi, jo doosre corner mein khadi thi, chup.

Kyunki Gauri ne SAHAY ko uss kaam mein laga diya tha.



Chapter 2: Wabistan

Bhuvan ka chehra sakht ho gaya. "Ye tumne kya kiya, Gauri?"

Gauri ne uski taraf dekha — thodi dheeli aankhon se, par awaaz seedhi thi. "SAHAY hamesha ke liye band nahi hua. Ek baar mujhe in teen dinon ka data dekh lene do — wapas online aa jayega."

"Abhi mujhe jaane do," usne kaha. "Jitna late karenge, utna hi late hoga."

Aur wo wahan se chali gayi — kisi ko jawab dene ka mauka diye bina.

Bhuvan wahan khada raha, dimaag kuch samajh nahi paa raha tha. Truck ka trace beech mein ruk gaya, SAHAY offline, aur ab Gauri bhi chali gayi apne raaste.

Mikhail ne uske kandhe par haath rakha. "Kuch na kuch hoga jayega, Bhuvan. Abhi hume kuch aur karna hoga."

Bhuvan ne ek gehri saans li. Time waste karne ka mauka nahi tha.

Usne seedha apne aadmiyon ko bulaya. "Poore area ki talashi lo. Har corner. Har raasta jahan wo truck ja sakta tha."

Aadmi nikal gaye.

6-7 ghante beet gaye.

Jab wo wapas aaye, sabke chehron par thakaan thi — aur kuch nahi mila tha.

"Sir, humne poora area check kiya," ek ne kaha. "Kahin kuch nahi mila."

Bhuvan ne unki taraf gaur se dekha. Kuch missing tha.

"Wabistan ka area check kiya?" usne poochha.

Sab ek doosre ko dekhne lage. Khamoshi.

"Sir, wahan koi nahi jaata," ek ne dheere se kaha.

"Kyun?" Bhuvan ki awaaz mein sawaal tha, par irritation bhi.

Wahi aadmi thoda aage aaya. "Sir, main Asli kahani bataata hoon aapko."

Bhuvan ne haan mein sar hilaya.

"Bahut saal pehle," usne shuru kiya, "Wabistan gaon mein sirf 3-4 families rehti thi. Chhota sa gaon, shaant jagah. Par ek din decide hua ki wahan ek hospital banega — isliye poora gaon khaali karna padega."

"Sab log maan gaye. Koi jhagda nahi hua. Unhi mein se ek aadmi tha jiska apna dhaba tha — usne kaha ki jab tak construction ka kaam chalega, wo apne dhabe se khana bhijwata rahega workers ke liye."

"Aise hi chalta raha kuch waqt. Phir ek raat — dhabe ka ek naukar khana dene gaya construction site par. Aur wahan ki chhat se gir gaya. Wahin uski maut ho gayi."

Bhuvan chup sunta raha.

"Uske baad se hospital ka kaam kabhi poora nahi hua. Jitne investors the — sabki maut ho gayi, ek ke baad ek. Koi bimari nahi, koi accident clear nahi — sab unknown reasons."

"Log kehte hain uska bhoot wahan hai. Kisi ko aane nahi deta. Uska naam padh gaya hai — Mahoshasur."

"Isliye sir, koi udhar nahi jaata."

Bhuvan ka gussa phoot pada.

"Ye kya bakwaas hai!" usne zor se kaha, table par haath maarte hue. "Bhoot pret kuch nahi hota! Aisa kuch nahi hota!"

Kamre mein sannata cha gaya. Aadmi ek doosre ko dekhne lage, sar jhukaye.

Tabhi Mikhail room mein aayi.

Usne ek nazar sabko dekha, phir dheere se kaha, "Sorry. Aap sab thodi der ke liye bahar chale jaayein, please."

Sab chup chaap nikal gaye — kuch relief mein, kuch dabe hue chehron ke saath.

Mikhail Bhuvan ke paas aayi.

"Kyun chilla rahe ho unpe?" usne poochha, awaaz sakht thi par thandi bhi. "Unke bhi ghar mein koi intezaar kar raha hoga. Koi risk nahi lena chahta apni jaan ka — ye galat baat nahi hai."

Bhuvan ne apna sar hilaya, frustration mein. "Aisa kuch nahi hota, Mikhail. Bhoot pret real nahi hote."

Mikhail ek pal ke liye chup rahi. Phir uski taraf dekha — seedhe, gehri nazar se.

"Ek time tha," usne kaha, "jab tum maante the ki God nahi hote."

"Aaj ke samay mein — tumhara bhai khud God ban chuka hai."

Bhuvan kuch keh nhi paaya



Chapter 3: The Night at hospital

Khana table par laga tha. Bhuvan aur Mikhail baithe the — thakaan bhare din ke baad ka simple sa dinner, dal-chawal, ek sabzi. Bahar raat ho chuki thi, kamre mein sirf TV ki halki roshni thi.

Plates mein khaana thoda hi khaya tha ki TV ki awaaz achanak tez ho gayi.

News anchor screen par thi — sakht chehra, urgent tone.

"Breaking News — SAHAY is offline. Sanjivani ke defects se judi khabarein, aur Om ka itne dinon se media mein na aana — kya ye IKS ke downfall ki shuruaat hai?"

Screen ke neeche red strip chal rahi thi — headlines ek ke baad ek, jaise koi countdown ho raha ho.

Bhuvan ka haath ruk gaya. Roti adhi tooti reh gayi uske haath mein.

Usne ek baar Mikhail ki taraf dekha. Uski aankhon mein kuch tha jo Mikhail ne pehle kabhi nahi dekha tha — ek mix, chinta aur gussa aur bebasi, sab ek saath.

Kuch bola nahi Bhuvan. Bas plate side mein dhakel di, chair peeche khisaki — awaaz itni tez thi ki floor par ghisti reh gayi — aur uth khada hua.

"Bhuvan—" Mikhail ne kaha, par wo already gaadi ki chabhi utha chuka tha.

Garage mein andhera tha, sirf ek bulb jal raha tha upar. Bhuvan seedha driver seat ki taraf badha.

"Kahan ja raha hai itni raat ko?" Mikhail ne uske peeche aate hue poochha, awaaz mein hairani thi.

"Wabistan," Bhuvan ne kaha — seedha, bina ruke, jaise faisla pehle hi ho chuka ho.

"Raat ko?" Mikhail ki awaaz ab thodi tez ho gayi. "Tu pagal ho gaya hai kya? Din mein bhi jo log wahan jaane se darte hain — tu raat ko jaayega?"

"Mujhe kuch nahi pata," Bhuvan ne kaha, gaadi ka darwaza khola. "Main ja raha hoon."

Mikhail ek pal ke liye khadi rahi — usne Bhuvan ke chehre ko dekha, uski aankhon mein wo hi purana zid tha jo Ishaan mein bhi hota tha, jo shayad poore parivaar mein tha.

"Toh main bhi jaaungi," usne kaha, seedha doosri taraf jaake baith gayi. "Tere saath."

Bhuvan ne ek pal uski taraf dekha. Kuch keh nahi paaya — ek toh waqt nahi tha, doosra, kuch nahi tha keh ne ko.

"Theek hai," itna hi bola.

Gaadi start hui, garage se nikli, sadko par daudne lagi. Shehr ki roshniyan dheere dheere peeche chhutne lagi — pehle dense, phir sparse, phir bilkul nahi.

Karib ek se dedh ghante mein wo Wabistan pahunche.

Raasta khatam hota gaya, kachi sadak shuru ho gayi. Gaadi ki headlights ke alawa kahin koi roshni nahi thi. Aas paas sirf sunsaan khet, sukhe ped, aur ek khamoshi jo shehr mein kabhi nahi hoti.

Aur phir — building dikhi.

Andhere mein bhi uska size mehsoos hota tha. Badi, ooncha, adhoora. Neeche se pehli do-teen manzilein poori tarah bani hui thi — glass, concrete, sab kuch professional lag raha tha. Par uske upar — scaffolding lagi thi, sariyaan bahar nikli hui thi, jaise kaam beech mein hi ruk gaya ho aur kabhi wapas shuru na hua ho.

Bhuvan ne gaadi park ki. Dono utre.

Hawa mein ek ajeeb si thandak thi — mausam ke hisaab se zyada.

Bhuvan aur Mikhail building ki taraf badhe. Kadam dheere the, par ruke nahi.

Darwaza — bada, lohe ka, thoda jang laga hua — Bhuvan ne dhakka diya. Chidchidati awaaz ke saath khula.

Andar ghuste.

Aur andar ghuste hi — barish shuru ho gayi.

Itni tez, itni achanak, ki dono ek pal ke liye ruk gaye. Bahar aasman saaf tha jab wo aaye the. Ab building ke andar se dekh rahe the ki bahar paani girne laga — jaise mausam ne apna raasta hi badal diya ho, sirf inn dono ke liye.

Tabhi ek awaaz aayi — table par kuch girne ki.

Dono ne dekha.

Ek purana radio tha, table ke ek kone se neeche gira — aur girte hi, apne aap, on ho gaya.

Ek gaana bajne laga.

"Rain rain go away, come again another day, little Johnny wants to play."

Par tune wo bachon wali rhyme jaisi nahi thi. Kuch tha usmein jo galat lagta tha — dheeme, khichi hui awaaz, jaise koi purani cassette galat speed par chal rahi ho, jaise koi bahut door se, bahut neeche se gaa raha ho.

Mikhail ke roongte khade ho gaye. "Bhuvan—" usne dheere se kaha, haath uske bazu ko pakadte hue. "Classic horror movies ki tarah, gate abhi tak band nahi hua hai. Hum ja sakte hain. Chal, nikalte hain yahan se."

Bhuvan ne uski taraf nahi dekha. Uski nazar radio par tiki thi.

"Tereko jaana hai toh ja," usne kaha — flat, bina emotion ke.

Mikhail ek pal ruki. Phir usne apni pakad aur mazboot kar li. "Ab tu classic horror movies ka sabse pehle marne wala aadmi mat ban. Chal yahan se, please."

Bhuvan seedha uski taraf muda. Uski aankhon mein ab wo purani thakaan nahi thi — kuch aur tha. Kuch jo bahut der se dabaya hua tha.

"Tereko kya lagta hai," usne kaha, awaaz mein ek dabi hui shiddat thi, "IKS ki reputation isliye important hai kyunki wo humara ghar chalata hai? Ya kyunki meri image usse bani hai?"

Ek pal ka pause.

"Wo important hai," usne kaha, awaaz thodi kaanp gayi, "kyunki wo mere bhai ki aakhri nishaani hai."

Mikhail kuch bol nahi paayi. Uske haath ki pakad dheeli pad gayi.

Aur tabhi —

Gate band ho gaya. Zor ki awaaz ke saath, apne aap, jaise kisi ne bahar se dhakka diya ho.

Dono ek pal ke liye still ho gaye.

Phir Mikhail ne dheere se, jaise haar maante hue, kaha: "Ab toh darwaza bhi band ho gaya. Ab toh nahi jaaungi chodke. Jo hoga, saath mein dekhenge."

Bhuvan ne uski taraf dekha — ek chhoti si nazar — aur dono aage ki taraf badhe, andar ki taraf, jahan andhera aur gehra hota jaa raha tha.

Tabhi upar se ek awaaz aayi.

Kuch girne jaisi. Ya kisi ke chalne jaisi — dheeme, bhaari kadam, jaise koi upar wali manzil par ghoom raha ho.

Dono ne upar dekha, phir ek doosre ko.

Par dono ki nazron mein bilkul alag cheez thi.

Mikhail ki aankhon mein darr tha — saaf,

Bhuvan ki aankhon mein — interest. Jaise wo jaanna chahta ho ki upar kya hai. Jaise darr se zyada zaroori kuch aur tha uske liye.



Chapter 4: Mahosasur

Wo dono seedhi chadhte gaye, upar ki taraf. Har kadam ke saath barish ki awaaz aur tez hoti gayi, jaise poori building bhi saans le rahi ho.

Upar pahunche.

Ek khaali floor tha — adhoora, concrete ka farsh, khambe khade the bina wall ke. Andhera itna gehra tha ki apna haath bhi mushkil se dikhta.

Koi nahi tha wahan. Koi nahi dikh raha tha.

Mikhail ki nazar ek corner mein gayi — kuch ek purane, mele kapde se dhaka hua tha, upar se neeche tak. Wo dheere se uski taraf badhi, kadam saavdhaan.

Usne kapda hataya.

Neeche — ek machine thi. Purani, dhool jami hui, par pehchaan mein aa rahi thi.

Sanjivani ki machine.

Mikhail ki saans ruk gayi. Usne palat kar Bhuvan ko bulana chaha —

Par uski awaaz gale mein hi atak gayi.

"Bhuvan—" itna hi nikal paayi.

Bhuvan uski taraf bhaga. "Kya hua?"

Mikhail ka haath kaanp raha tha. Usne bas ishaara kiya — "Peeche mudke dekh."

Bhuvan mudta hai.

Aur wahan khada tha —

Mahosasur.

Poora sharir laal, jaise andar se kuch jal raha ho. 8 foot ka — building ki chhat ke kareeb sar. Kaale singh, sar se do taraf nikle hue. Kaale, bade nakhun,

Bhuvan ki saans ruk gayi. Pair zameen se chipak gaye, hilna mushkil ho gaya.

Mahosasur ne apna ek haath uthaya — dheere se, jaise koi ishaara kar raha ho.

Aur Mikhail hawa mein udd gayi. Ek jhatke mein — jaise koi force use upar khainch raha ho — wo zameen se do foot upar float karne lagi, uske pair hawa mein latakte hue.

Uski aankhon se — eyeballs gayab ho gaye. Sirf khaali, safed jagah reh gayi.

"MIKHAIL!" Bhuvan chillaya.

Usne bina soche Mahosasur ki taraf daudkar ek zor ka mukka maara — seedha uske sine par.

Kuch nahi hua.

Uلتا — Bhuvan ke haath mein aisi chot lagi jaise usne concrete ki deewar par maara ho. Wo peeche gira, kalai pakde, dard se munh bigadta hua.

"Ye kya kar rahe ho?" Bhuvan chillaya, uthte hue. "Mikhail ko chhodo! Mereko jo karna hai karo — par isse chhodo!"

Mahosasur ki awaaz aayi — bhaari, gehri, jaise kai awaazein ek saath bol rahi hon.

"Darro mat. Usko kuch nahi hoga. Agar tum mera kaam karoge."

Bhuvan ne haanphte hue poochha, "Kaunsa kaam?"

"Jo karna hai wo karunga," Mahosasur ne kaha. "Pehle — ek kahani sunata hoon."

Aur Mikhail wahin float karti rahi, hawa mein latki, aankhein khaali.

"Bahut saal pehle," Mahosasur ne shuru kiya, "yahan ek hospital ban raha tha. Ek raat mere maalik ne mujhe kaha — 'ye le, ye khaana pahunchaake aa jaa.' Maine dekha ki koi neeche nahi hai, toh main upar gaya — khaana pahunchaane."

"Wahan unki baat chal rahi thi — ki wo yahan ke underground mein kya kya illegal business khol sakte hain. Maine ye sun liya tha. Par galti se mere se ek pot gir gaya. Unhone uski awaaz sun li."

"Unhone mujhe pakad liya. Paise diye chup rehne ke liye. Par main tha imaandaar aadmi — maine mana kar diya."

"Toh mujhe wahin dhakel diya. Log samjhe main gir gaya — accident."

"Uske baad se main ek naye species ka member ban gaya. Uska alag hi dimension hai — NUPUR. Wahan saare souls rehte hain. Aur wahan bhi — Earth ki tarah — alag alag caste systems chalte hain."

"Par yahan caste unchi karne ke liye ek gem paana padta hai. Bahut powerful gem hai wo."

"Isliye maine socha — wo gem paalu. Par use paana asaan nahi hai. Uske liye kisi dimaag wale ki zaroorat hai."

"Isliye insaanon ko control karke maine Sanjivani yahan layi — taaki isse khojte khojte Om yahan aaye, aur main usse ye kaam karwaau."

"Par yahan tum aa gaye."

Bhuvan ka dimaag tez chal raha tha, dard ke bawajood. "Jab tum insaanon ka dimaag control kar sakte ho," usne kaha, "toh mujhe mana kyun rahe ho ye kaam karne ke liye?"

Mahosasur ki laal aankhein Bhuvan par tik gayi.

"Tumhe jo karne ko kaha gaya hai," usne kaha, awaaz mein koi bahas ki gunjaish nahi thi, "wo karo."

Bhuvan ne ek baar Mikhail ki taraf dekha — hawa mein latki hui, bebas, khaali aankhon ke saath.

Bhuvan ke paas koi aur option nahi tha



Chapter 5: Nawmani

Gauri baithi thi, laptop ke saamne — screens par footage chal raha tha, wahi teen din ka data jo usne SAHAY se nikalwaya tha.

Uski aankhein videos par tiki thi, par haath kaanp rahe the.

Jab sab dekh chuki, wo ek pal ke liye bilkul still baithi rahi. Phir usne SAHAY ko wapas online kiya.

"SAHAY, sab kuch restore kar do. Abhi."

"Restore ho raha hai," SAHAY ne kaha.

Gauri uthi, seedha bahar bhaagi. Bhuvan aur Mikhail ko batana tha — jo usne dekha tha, jo samjha tha — sab kuch.

Par jab wo unke room mein pahunchi — koi nahi tha.

Usne poori building chhaan maari. Bhuvan nahi. Mikhail nahi.

Tabhi uski nazar Avika par padi, jo corridor mein akeli khadi thi.

"Avika," Gauri jhukte hue bola, "tumhare Papa Mummy kahan hain?"

Avika ne masoom si nazron se dekha. "Main bhi unhe dhundh rahi thi. Papa ne meri drawing ka gift nahi diya tha na."

Gauri ka dil ek pal ke liye ruk gaya.

Cut to — Wabistan.

Mahosasur Bhuvan ko lekar usi underground basement mein le gaya jahan investors kabhi illegal business ki baatein karte the. Andhera, seelan bhari deewarein, aur bhaari khamoshi.

Wahan Mahosasur ne apna haath uthaya — aur hawa mein ek portal khula. Roshni ka ek gol daayra, jiske andar se ek alag hi jagah dikh rahi thi.

"Kya ye Nupir hai?" Bhuvan ne poochha, dabi hui awaaz mein.

"Nahi," Mahosasur ne kaha. "Ye gem itna khaas hai ki use universe ke raaste ke beech mein rakha gaya hai. Jao."

Bhuvan ne ruk kar poochha, "Iska naam kya hai?"

"Alag alag log alag alag naamon se jaante hain use," Mahosasur ne kaha, uski awaaz mein pehli baar kuch najuk sa sunayi diya. "Koi ise Divya Mani kehta hai, koi Paras. Par mujhe sabse achha lagta hai — Nawmani."

Bhuvan portal ke andar gaya.

Aur usne dekha —

singularity sphere kaat raha tha. Ghoomta hua, apne aap ko cut karta hua, jaise koi khud ko toda ja raha ho.

Bhuvan confuse ho gaya. Ye kaat kyun raha hai?

Tabhi SAHAY ki awaaz aayi, uske kaan ke paas — "Kyunki Om ne har universe ke main task ko tod diya."

Bhuvan chauk gaya. "SAHAY? Tum ho? Gauri ne retrieve kar liya — main phir se online hoon."

Bhuvan ne turant SAHAY ko saari baatein bataayi — Mahosasur, Nawmani, sab kuch.

SAHAY ne sun kar kaha, "Iske baare mein main jaanta hoon. Asal mein — iske baare mein toh Ishaan ki uss universe ki kitaab mein likha hai."

"Konsa universe?" Bhuvan ne poochha.

"Abhi ye important nahi," SAHAY ne kaha. "Tumhe pata hai wo khud kyun nahi karta ye kaam?"

"Kyun?"

"Jo aatma hoti hai — Mahosatur jaisi — wo Earth aur Nupir ke alawa kisi bhi universe mein reh sakti hai. Par agar aise kisi universe mein jaaye, jaisa ye hai, toh wo jal jaate hain. Aur unki powers bhi yahan kaam nahi karti."

"Isliye wo mind control se tujhe yahan nahi bhejna chahta tha — kyunki tu yahan aate hi uski kaid se bahar ho jaata."

Bhuvan ne aage badte hue dekha — saamne Nawmani thi, ek chhoti si roshni jaisi gem, hawa mein tairti hui.

Par uske aur mani ke beech mein ek aadmi khada tha.

"Ye mani ka rakshak hai," SAHAY ne kaha. "Iske aas paas laser hain. Ye soya rehta hai — par laser se touch hote hi alarm bajta hai, jisse ye uth jaata hai."

"Isliye Mahosatur ne ek intelligent aadmi chuna jo ye laser band kar sake."

Bhuvan ne dheere se, gaur se, ek ek laser ka pattern dekha. Uska dimaag tez chalne laga — jaise koi puzzle solve kar raha ho.

Ek ek karke usne raasta banaya, laser ke beech se nikalta gaya, saans roke hue, kadam sambhal ke.

Alarm nahi baja.

Bhuvan ne haath badhaya, mani ko uthaya.

Aur wapas mud gaya.

Portal se bahar aaya, seedha Mahosatur ke paas.

Mani ko Bhuvan ke haath mein dekh kar Mahosatur ki laal aankhein aur chamak uthi. Uska poori sharir kaanp raha tha — excitement se ya lalach se.

"Mani do," usne kaha, haath aage badhate hue.

"Pehle Mikhail ko chhodo," Bhuvan ne seedha kaha.

Mahosatur ne ek pal socha, phir Mikhail ko chhod diya. Wo zameen par gir gayi, haanphti hui, par zinda, hosh mein.

Bhuvan ne mani de diya. Phir Mikhail ki taraf dekha. "Bahar jao. Jaake SAHAY ko on kar do."

Mikhail uthi, ek nazar Bhuvan ko dekha, phir bahar bhaagi.

Par Bhuvan wahin ruka rah gaya.

Mahosasur mani ke lalach mein itna dooba tha ki usne notice bhi nahi kiya. Usne mani ko apne locket mein laga liya —

Aur jaise hi laga, uski body mein energy jaane ke bajaye — kheech li gayi.

Mahosasur ka chehra badla. "Ye... ye kya hua?"

Bhuvan peeche hatte hue bola, "SAHAY ne jo mantra bataya tha — usse mani ka asar ulta ho sakta hai."

Mahosasur ka gussa phoot pada, poora sharir laal se aur gehra ho gaya. "Tumne — DHOKHA diya!"

"Ab tere paas power nahi," Bhuvan ne kaha, seedha uski aankhon mein dekhte hue. "Bas ye aath foot ka sharir hai, aur bade nakhun."

Bhuvan siddhi ki taraf bhaga — upar, chhat ki taraf.

Mahosasur uske peeche daudha.

Chaar manzil upar, khuli chhat par pahunchte hi, Bhuvan ne ek pal bhi nahi socha — seedha neeche ki taraf kood gaya.

Mahosasur bhi peeche kooda, garjta hua, ek ke peeche ek.

Par Bhuvan ke joote mein jets the.

Neeche girte girte achanak wo hawa mein udd gaya, seedha, control mein.

Neeche dekha — Mahosasur zameen ki taraf tez giri, aur wahin, neeche khadi Mikhail, haath mein ek chhoti si machine liye — usne button dabaya.

Ek flash. Aur Mahosasur — evaporate ho gaya. Hawa mein bikhar gaya, jaise kabhi tha hi nahi.

Bhuvan neeche utra, saans phooli hui, par chehre par sukoon tha.

Mikhail ne machine haath mein pakde rakhi thi. "Tune hi diya tha na ye device — pehle."

Bhuvan ne muskuraya, haan mein sar hilaya.

Dono ne poore Sanjivani ke real, saaf models ikattha kiye — jo asal mein safe the, jo build kiye gaye the sahi tareeke se — aur seedha IKS office pahunche.

Agle din ek press conference bulai gayi.

Bhuvan aur Mikhail stage par khade the — thake hue, par seedhe, sach ke saath.

Unhone poori kahani bataayi — Sanjivani ke defects ka asli source, Wabistan ka saara sach, Mahosasar, sab kuch — jitna bataya ja sakta tha.

Media chup sunta raha.

Aur dheere dheere — IKS ki reputation, dheere dheere, wapas aane lagi.

